Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Thursday, 15 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Overcast	Rain	Drizzle	Rain
20° 16°	20° 11°	18° 12°	15° 9°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **A family has paid a heartbreaking tribute to a 'warm and engaging' man killed in a tiger attack at a wildlife park.**
William Chapman died after he entered the tiger's enclosure at Yorkshire Wildlife Park. The park has expressed its deepest condolences and is cooperating with investigations.
TRAGEDY · UK

2 **The government is launching a review into airport drop-off charges, following a sharp increase in fees across the UK.**
Ministers say it's 'vital to ensure travel remains accessible and that passengers are treated fairly'. Many airports have significantly hiked charges in recent years.
TRAVEL · UK

3 **A civil servant is accused of faking illness with make-up to juggle five jobs simultaneously, a court has heard.**
Kashim Chowdhury allegedly took advantage of working from home to manage multiple government roles. The prosecution claims he used make-up to appear unwell for sick days.
COURT · UK

4 **Hundreds of Royal Mail staff are reportedly quitting each week, as new efficiency plans cause widespread dissatisfaction.**
The CWU union claims a new delivery system is not working in hundreds of offices, leading to a significant exodus of posties. This could impact postal services nationwide.
WORK · UK

5 **The Met Office has issued a yellow wind warning for parts of the UK, with gales and heavy rain expected.**
North-west Scotland is braced for gusts of up to 70mph, as forecasters warn of disruptive weather. Other areas could also see significant rainfall.
WEATHER · UK

02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **Good news for fans of Lena Dunham's hit show 'Girls' – it's set to return for a limited HBO run!**

Ten years after the series finale, the original cast are getting back together. This time, they'll be exploring the 'milestone of turning forty'.

ON AIR — Are you excited to see where the 'Girls' are now? What do you hope they've been up to?

TV · COMING UP

2 **Robert Pattinson is starring in a new film, 'Primetime', exploring how hunting predators became hit TV.**

He portrays the real-life host of the American TV show 'To Catch a Predator'. It promises to be a gripping look at a controversial topic.

ON AIR — Robert Pattinson has taken on some really interesting roles lately. What's your favourite of his recent films?

FILM · COMING UP

3 **Star of 'The Gentlemen', Ray Winstone, has been charming locals in a Welsh market town while filming his new project.**

Winstone is playing an ex-SAS operative in the action-comedy 'Danger Money'. It sounds like he's making quite an impression!

ON AIR — What's your favourite Ray Winstone role? He always brings such a presence to the screen!

FILM · COMING UP

4 **Award-winning singer Raye has hit back at ticket touts after an incredible 1.8 million people signed up for her 5,000-seat Royal Albert Hall show.**

The demand for her tickets was absolutely huge, showing just how popular she is right now. She's clearly frustrated about genuine fans missing out.

ON AIR — Have you ever been caught out by ticket touts, or missed out on a show because of them? It's so frustrating!

MUSIC · THIS WEEK

5 **The Pussycat Dolls say dancing together again was 'surreal', with Nicole Scherzinger telling them she was 'proud'.**

The group reflected on their recent performances, clearly enjoying being back on stage. It sounds like a great reunion for the band!

ON AIR — What's your favourite Pussycat Dolls song? Were you a fan back in the day?

MUSIC · THIS WEEK

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **A star-studded Saudi exhibition tennis event, featuring Carlos Alcaraz and Novak Djokovic, has been postponed after deadly attacks.**

The 'Six Kings Slam' was set to bring some of the biggest names in tennis together. The decision was made following a series of deadly attacks on Saudi Arabia.

ON AIR — It's a real shame for tennis fans, but safety has to come first, doesn't it?

TENNIS · GLOBAL

2 **Real Madrid forward Vinicius Jr is set to miss the highly anticipated El Clasico against Barcelona after receiving a four-game ban.**

This is a massive blow for Real Madrid ahead of one of the biggest fixtures in the football calendar. His absence will be keenly felt.

ON AIR — How big a miss will Vinicius Jr be for Real Madrid in El Clasico? Who do you think will step up?

FOOTBALL · THIS WEEK

3 **Scotland's women's team came from behind twice to beat the Czech Republic and set up a World Cup play-off final against Sweden.**

It was a thrilling 3-2 victory in Paisley, securing a 5-2 aggregate win. They now face a tough challenge against Sweden for a spot in the World Cup.

ON AIR — What a performance from Scotland! Do you think they can go all the way and qualify for the World Cup?

FOOTBALL · UK

4 **Great Britain's women's team had to settle for silver after being beaten by China in the team sprint final at the Track Cycling World Championships.**

The event took place in Shanghai, with China proving too strong on their home track. Still, a silver medal is a fantastic achievement for GB!

ON AIR — Another great result for Team GB in cycling! Are you following the World Championships?

CYCLING · UK

5 **Manchester United manager Michael Carrick says 'the boys are hurting' after extending their winless run to five games.**

This follows a 2-0 defeat against Atletico Madrid in the Champions League. Pressure is mounting on the team and management.

ON AIR — What do you think is going wrong at Manchester United? Can they turn their season around?

FOOTBALL · UK

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1. **The humble art of 'doodling during meetings' is now being recognised for its surprising benefits.**
   Studies suggest that those little scribbles can actually help with concentration and memory retention. So next time you're sketching a rocket, tell your boss it's for cognitive enhancement!

2. **More of us are rediscovering the simple joy of 'window shopping without buying' as a leisurely pastime.**
   It's all about enjoying the visual feast and inspiration without the pressure of a purchase, turning a trip to the high street into a pleasant, no-cost outing.

3. **The trend for 'colour-coded bookshelves' is gaining traction, not just for aesthetics but also for mental well-being.**
   Arranging books by hue can create a sense of calm and order, making a home library feel even more inviting and less overwhelming.

4. **Embracing 'the art of the perfectly brewed cuppa' is becoming a small daily ritual for many.**
   From warming the pot to the ideal steeping time, people are finding quiet satisfaction in mastering this everyday act, turning it into a moment of mindful enjoyment.

5. **The delightful sound of 'rain on a conservatory roof' is being sought out for its soothing qualities.**
   It seems that gentle drumming sound, especially during an autumn shower, provides a natural, calming soundtrack for relaxation at home.

6. **A growing number of people are finding immense satisfaction in 'rescuing and restoring old pieces of furniture'.**
   Giving a tired chest of drawers or a wobbly chair a new lease of life offers a wonderful sense of accomplishment and a unique, personal touch to home décor.

7. **The unexpected pleasure of 'finding a matching pair of socks' in the laundry basket is proving to be a small daily triumph for many.**
   It's those little victories, isn't it? A testament to the chaos of the sock drawer and the joy of order restored!

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new jar of olives, especially if they're a fancy, artisan one. What is it?**

ANSWER: POURING A TINY BIT OF THE BRINE INTO A SEPARATE SPOON AND 'TASTING THE SEA' BEFORE ENJOYING THE OLIVE ITSELF!

Q **Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when trying to quickly judge if a new brand of ice cream will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?**

ANSWER: GENTLY TAPPING THE LID TO FEEL FOR THE PERFECT 'THUNK' THAT SUGGESTS A CREAMY, DENSE TEXTURE INSIDE.

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes a particular 'everyday item' just instantly makes you feel a bit nostalgic or takes you back to a specific time?**
  Perhaps it's an old film ticket, a well-worn recipe book, or even a particular brand of biscuit wrapper. What's that one item for you, and what memory does it unlock?

- **We all have that 'one small, everyday household task' that, for some reason, we find surprisingly therapeutic or satisfying to do.**
  Maybe it's organising the spice rack, polishing the chrome, or even just perfectly stacking the clean laundry. What's your oddly satisfying household chore?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **History.** Before alarm clocks were common, there were 'knocker-uppers' in Britain and Ireland who would tap on people's windows with long poles or throw peas at them to wake them up for work.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The first ever recorded 'traffic jam' in history was caused by a runaway herd of sheep in central London in the year 1742, blocking horse and cart traffic for over three hours.

06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of owls is called a parliament.
- Strawberries are the only fruit with seeds on the outside.
- The Great Fire of London in 1666 actually helped to stop the Great Plague, as it burnt down many rat-infested houses.
- The shortest complete sentence in the English language is 'Go'.
- Mars is known as the 'Red Planet' because of its high iron content, which rusts and gives the surface its distinctive colour.
- The sound of Big Ben is officially known as 'The Westminster Chimes'.
- The world's largest hot desert, the Sahara, is growing and expanding southward by about half a mile per month.
- It is impossible for most people to lick their own elbow.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES THU 15 OCT 2026

On this day

Day 288 of the year, 77 days left in 2026. Today Breast Health Day (Europe); Christian feast day: Gundisalvus of Lagos; Christian feast day: Magdalene of Nagasaki; Christian feast day: Teresa of Ávila. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1935 — Dick McTaggart, Scottish boxer (died 2025)
- 1935 — Barry McGuire, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1966 — Eric Benét, American singer-songwriter
- 1968 — Vanessa Marcil, American actress
- 1940 — Tommy Bishop, English rugby league player and coach
- 1992 — Vincent Martella, American actor
- 1979 — Jaci Velasquez, American singer-songwriter and actress
- 1959 — Alex Paterson, English keyboard player

THE DAY TODAY

- 1997 — The Cassini probe launches from Cape Canaveral on its way to Saturn.
- 2006 — The 6.7 Mw Kiholo Bay earthquake rocks Hawaii, causing property damage, injuries, landslides, power outages, and the closure of Honolulu International Airport.
- 2003 — China launches Shenzhou 5, its first crewed space mission.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2006 — The 6.7 Mw Kiholo Bay earthquake rocks Hawaii, causing property damage, injuries, landslides, power outages, and the closure of Honolulu International Airport.
- 1954 — Hurricane Hazel devastates the eastern seaboard of North America, killing 95 and causing massive floods as far north as Toronto.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2008 — The Dow Jones Industrial Average closes down 733.08 points, or 7.87%, the second worst percentage drop in the Dow's history.
- 1991 — The leaders of the Baltic States, Arnold Rüütel of Estonia, Anatolijs Gorbunovs of Latvia and Vytautas Landsbergis of Lithuania, signed the OSCE Final Act in Helsinki, Finland.

- 1979 — Supporters of the Malta Labour Party ransack and destroy the Times of Malta building and other locations associated with the Nationalist Party.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES FRI 16 OCT 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 289 of the year, 76 days left in 2026. Today Air Force Day (Bulgaria); Boss's Day (United States); Christian feast day: Balderic (Baudry) of Monfaucon; Christian feast day: Bertrand of Comminges. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1953 — Brinsley Forde, British singer and actor
- 2005 — Ruby Rose Turner, American actress
- 1936 — Peter Bowles, English actor and screenwriter (died 2022)
- 1969 — Wendy Wilson, American singer-songwriter
- 1958 — Tim Robbins, American actor, director, and screenwriter
- 1947 — David Zucker, American director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1967 — Davina McCall, English television host and actress
- 1971 — Chad Gray, American singer-songwriter and guitarist

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1978 — Cardinal Karol Wojtyła is elected to the papacy as Pope John Paul II, he becomes the first non-Italian pontiff since 1523.
- 1995 — The Million Man March takes place in Washington, D.C. About 837,000 attend.
- 1973 — Henry Kissinger and Lê Đức Thọ are awarded the Nobel Peace Prize.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1991 — George Hennard runs amok in Killeen, Texas, killing 23 and wounding 20.
- 1996 — Eighty-four football fans die and 180 are injured in a massive crush at a match in Guatemala City.

Prepflow

10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 · PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

© 2026 The Radio Business